

“Biting Bullets”: Social Media and *Razor Tongue*

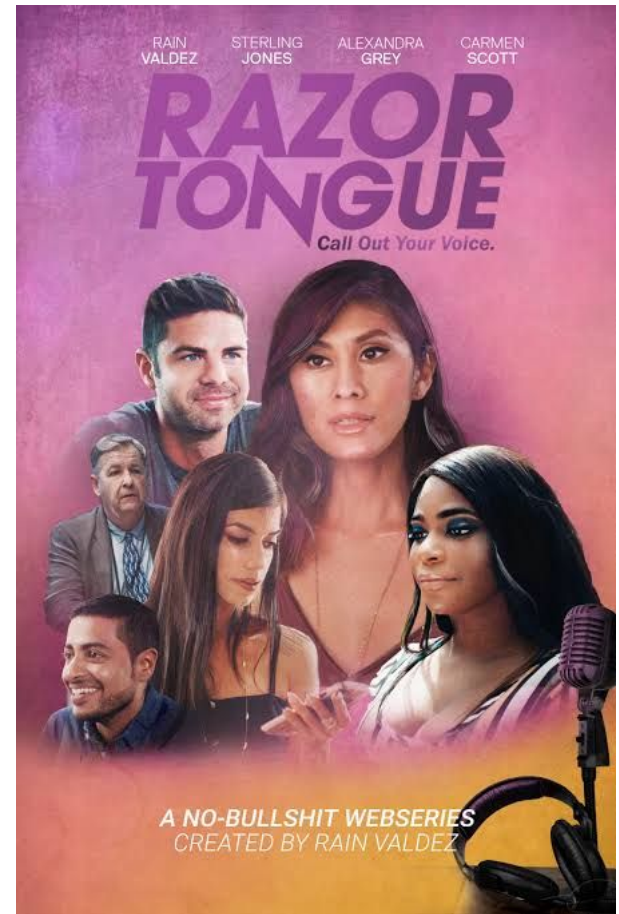
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Adapted from the original web series by Rain Valdez

What is *Razor Tongue*?



A scene from *Razor Tongue*.^[1]

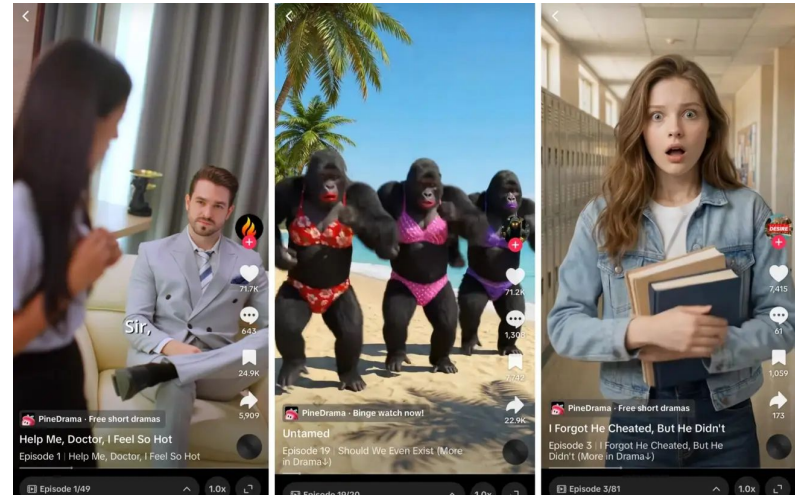


Razor Tongue promotional poster.^[1]

[1] Valdez, Rain, creator. *Razor Tongue*. Now>Ever, 2019, YouTube, www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLIML81phU1My81RbNUQpHADaGZB4hgI5A.

Thesis and technology used

My adaptation of the web series *Razor Tongue* by Rain Valdez will incorporate livestreaming and multilingual audience interaction from social media, allowing crowds to experience through active participation the polarising yet collective vitriol that fuels “cancel culture” along social, cultural, and community lines, as well as its consequences, in real time.



Examples of short dramas on the TikTok UI.^[2]



The season finale broadcast scene from *Razor Tongue*.^[1]

[2]
<https://www.businessinsider.com/tiktok-testing-mini-drama-feed-ai-2026-3>

Vision examples



Examples of *danmu*, or bullet comments, on Chinese platform Bilibili, during a livestream.^[3]



Examples of *danmaku*, or bullet comments, on Japanese platform NicoNico, during a livestream.^[4]



UK interactive performance group Blast Theory utilising live audience participation.^[5]

[3] https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Example-of-danmu-comments-on-BiliBili-where-user-comments-flow-on-top-of-the-video_fig3_309690585

[4] <https://nintendosoup.com/you-can-now-watch-live-broadcasts-on-niconico-switch/>

[5] <https://www.blasttheory.co.uk/holding-audiences-to-account/>

Belle's altered role



Examples of livestreamers on Chinese social media.^[6]



A professional portrait of Rain Valdez.^[7]

[6]

<https://technode.com/2022/06/23/china-further-tightens-rules-on-livestream-hosts-with-new-regulation/>

[7] <https://www.imdb.com/name/nm2759281/>

Drag culture



Drag queens and comedians Ginger Minj, Jinkx Monsoon, and Darienne Lake.^[8]



Bob the Drag Queen (and comedian).^[9]

[8] <https://www.comedydynamics.com/press/these-6-drag-race-legends-are-launching-stand-up-comedy-specials/>

[9] <https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/bob-the-drag-queen-hulu-comedy-special-this-is-wild-1236629691/>

Casting choices

Marsha P. Johnson and Sylvia Rivera, two instrumental figures in the fights for LGBTQ+ and transgender rights, and co-founders of the Street Transvestite Action Revolutionaries (STAR).^[10] Especially important representation for Black trans women and trans women of colour.



[10] <https://ncheteach.org/resource/sylvia-rivera-marsha-p-johnson-and-the-fight-for-trans-rights/>

What will audiences see?



Ariel interviewing Belle during the season finale.^[1]



Belle and Austin together in the closing scene.^[1]

What will audiences feel?



A depiction of the concept of cancel culture.^[11]



A depiction of the concept of cancel culture.^[12]

[11] <https://www.northbaybiz.com/2021/11/07/rising-above-our-cancel-culture-world/>

[12] <https://councils.forbes.com/blog/navigating-cancel-culture>

Why UCLA should run this adaptation



Recent graduates of UCLA Asian American Studies.^[13]

[13] <https://asianam.ucla.edu/>